Document Retention and Destruction Policy

PURPOSE

This policy governs the retention and destruction of the corporation's records in all forms, physical and electronic. Its purposes are to preserve the records the law and the corporation's work require, to destroy records on a schedule rather than by accident or impulse, and to suspend all destruction the moment litigation, audit, or investigation is reasonably anticipated.

RETENTION SCHEDULE

RECORD CLASS	RETENTION
Articles of Incorporation, bylaws, and amendments; board and committee minutes; resolutions and written consents; IRS determination letter and exemption application; annual reports to the Secretary of State; corporate seals and registrations	**Permanent**
Audit reports and year-end financial statements; general ledgers; tax returns and supporting filings (Form 990 and related)	**Permanent**
Conflict-of-interest disclosures; policies as adopted and superseded; insurance policies	**Permanent**
Contracts, grants, and agreements, including the fiscal sponsorship agreement	**7 years after expiration**
Bank statements, reconciliations, invoices, receipts, expense records, and payment authorizations	**7 years**
Donor and grant records, acknowledgments, and restricted-fund documentation	**7 years**
Research records: protocols, consents, and data as required by the applicable review body or partner institution, whichever is longer	**7 years minimum**
Personnel and volunteer records	**7 years after separation**
Routine correspondence and general email of no legal, fiscal, or historical significance	**3 years**

CUSTODY

Permanent records are kept in the corporation's Corporate Records shared drive, maintained by the Secretary. Records are stored so that they survive any individual's departure, with at least one current backup independent of the primary copy.

Within thirty calendar days of the end of each calendar quarter, the Secretary prints all records added to the Corporate Records drive since the prior quarter and adds them to the corporation's hardcopy record set, kept in a locked safe at the principal office of the corporation.

The Chair verifies each quarterly addition at the time of deposit and signs a statement that the hardcopy set has been observed to match the digital record. Signed verifications are filed with the corporate records. This deposit is an interim control; the Records Custody Rollout Plan governs its conversion to the corporation’s standard practice, on the board’s resolution.

DESTRUCTION

Records past their retention period are destroyed once per year on the Secretary's authorization, after the fiscal year closes and the annual information return is filed, by shredding or secure deletion. Records containing personal, participant, or confidential information are destroyed by methods that prevent recovery.

SUSPENSION

If litigation, a government investigation, or an audit is pending or reasonably anticipated, all destruction under this policy stops immediately for related records, on notice from any officer. Destruction resumes only when the Secretary confirms the hold is lifted.

ADMINISTRATION

The Secretary administers this policy and reviews it with the board at each annual meeting, alongside the annual conflict-of-interest disclosures. Questions about whether a record may be destroyed are resolved in favor of retention.

Adopted by the Board of Directors of Luminara Institute of Light on ____________________, 2026, pursuant to Article X of the bylaws.